

Subtracting on a Number Path

Answer Key

Kindergarten / Grade 1

Quick Answers

1. 4	4. 2	7. 4	10. 2
2. 5	5. 2	8. 3	
3. 6	6. 5	9. 8	

Curriculum

Level: Kindergarten / Grade 1

1.OA.C.6 – *problems 4, 6, 7, 9, 10*

K.OA.A – *problems 1, 2, 3, 5, 8*

Difficulty 1–4 of 5 across 10 tagged checks.

1. $6 - 2$. Put a finger on square 6. Hop left once to 5, twice to 4. Two hops taken, so the finger stops on 4. 4

Listen for: a child who lands on 5 counted the starting square as the first hop. Say “six” on the square, then start counting at the first hop.

2. $8 - 3$. Start on 8. Hop left: 7, 6, 5. Three hops, so the answer is the square under the finger. 5

3. $10 - 4$. Start on 10 and hop left four times: 9, 8, 7, 6. 6

4. $9 - 7$. Counting back seven times is a long way. The two numbers are close, so count *up* instead: start on 7, hop right to 8, hop right to 9. That is two hops, and the number of hops is the difference. 2

Why it works: 7 and 2 more make 9, so 9 take away 7 leaves 2.

5. $7 - 5$. Start on 7 and hop back five times: 6, 5, 4, 3, 2. The circled square is the answer. 2

Counting up from 5 to 7 gives the same 2 — a good chance to show the child that both routes agree.

6. $9 - \underline{\hspace{1cm}} = 4$. Here the number of hops is missing, not the landing square. Put one finger on 9 and one on 4, then count the hops between them: 8, 7, 6, 5, 4. That is five hops, so five is what was taken away. 5

Check by hopping back: 9 hop back 5 lands on 4. Correct.

7. $10 - 6$. Start on 6 and hop right until the finger reaches 10: 7, 8, 9, 10. Four hops. 4

8. Eight frogs, five hop away. The story says take away, so start on 8 and hop back five squares: 7, 6, 5, 4, 3. Three frogs are still on the log. 3

Accept a drawing of five crossed-out frogs as well — it is the same idea.

9. $\underline{\quad} - 3 = 5$. This time the *start* is missing. Undo the subtraction: begin on the answer, 5, and hop *up* three squares: 6, 7, 8. Starting on 8 and hopping back 3 does land on 5, so the start number is right. 8

10. Mia had ten stickers and gave eight away. Counting back eight times invites a miscount. The two numbers are close, so count up: start on 8 and hop right to 9, then to 10. Two hops, so Mia has two stickers left. 2

The point of the problem: choosing to count up instead of back is the skill, not the answer. Praise the choice.